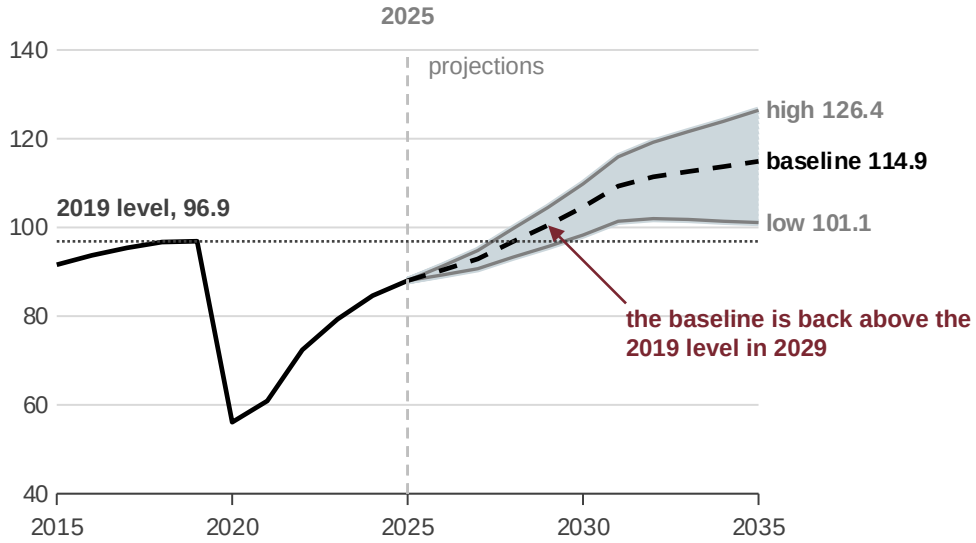
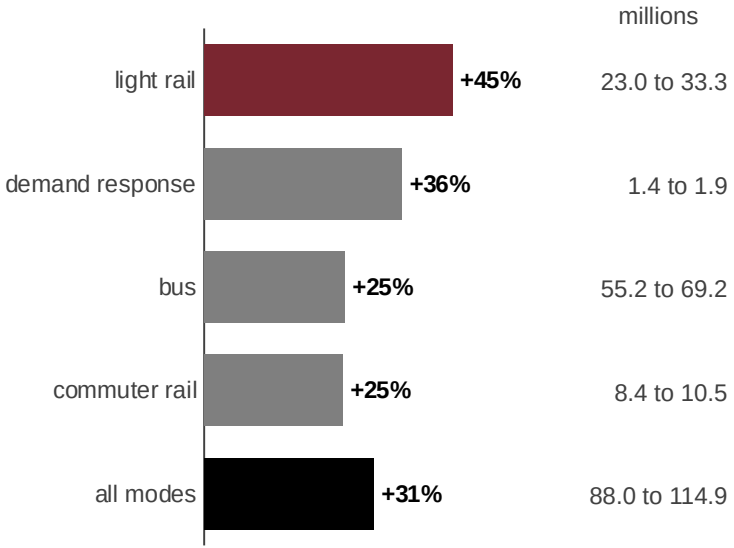
Ridership passes its 2019 level in 2029 in the baseline; light rail grows fastest, up 45% from 2025 to 2035

Annual boardings, all modes, by ridership case
millions



Growth in boardings, 2025-2035, by mode
percent, baseline; boardings in 2025 and 2035 at right

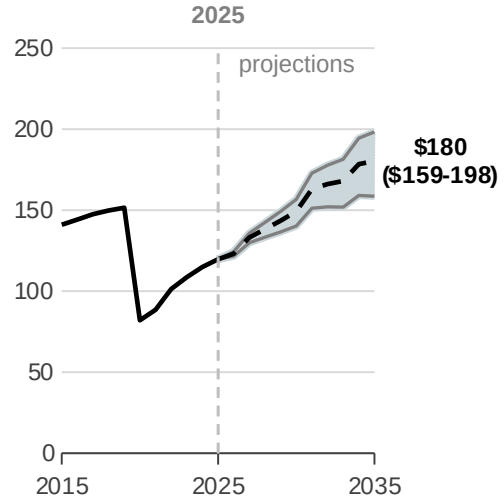


Data source: Lakeshore Regional Transit Authority, Ten-Year Capital and Ridership Outlook 2026 (fictional agency; illustrative figures)
Note: The low and high cases scale every mode alike, to 0.88 and 1.10 times the baseline in 2035; they pass the 2019 level in 2028 and 2030.

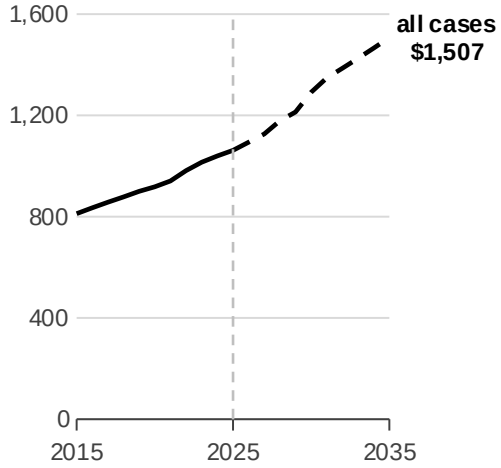
Fare revenue grows 51% by 2035, yet farebox recovery ends at 10.5-13.2%, below 2019's 16.8% in every case

history, then the baseline dashed after 2025 low and high ridership cases, with the range between them shaded

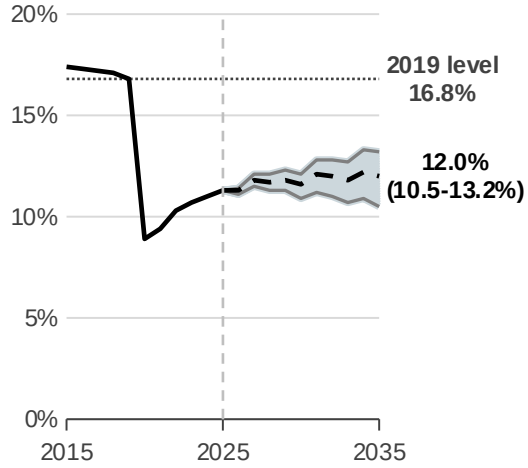
Fare revenue
$ million, nominal



Operating cost
$ million, nominal



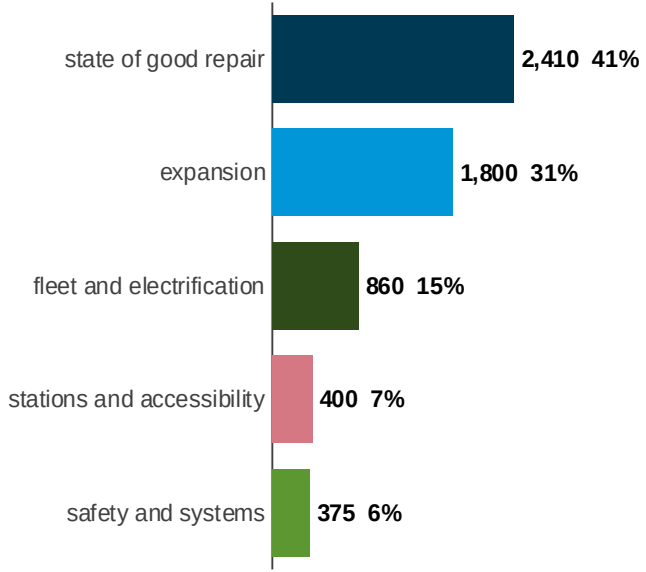
Farebox recovery
fare revenue as a percent of operating cost



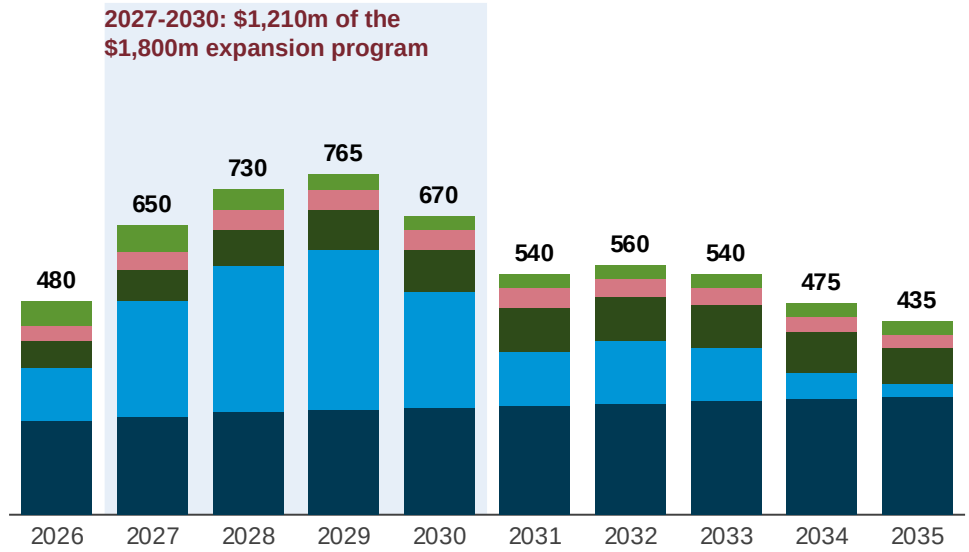
Data source: Lakeshore Regional Transit Authority, Ten-Year Capital and Ridership Outlook 2026 (fictional agency; illustrative figures)
Note: Fares rise 5% for every mode in 2027, 2031 and 2034. Operating cost is the same in all three cases; the cases differ in ridership, and so in fare revenue.

State of good repair takes 41% of the $5.8 billion plan; two-thirds of expansion spending falls in 2027-2030

Ten-year total by program
$ million; share of the $5,845 million plan



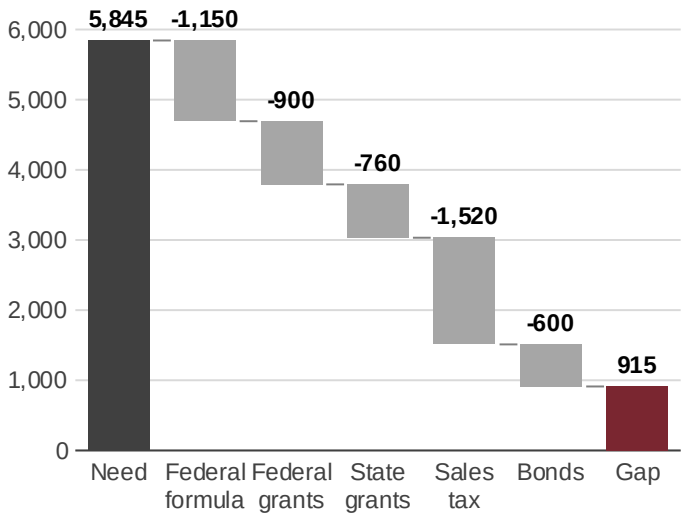
Capital plan by year and program
$ million, year of expenditure; colours as in the left chart



Data source: Lakeshore Regional Transit Authority, Ten-Year Capital and Ridership Outlook 2026 (fictional agency; illustrative figures)
Note: Year-of-expenditure dollars. Expansion = Blue Line extension, Lakefront BRT and Crosstown BRT.

Identified sources cover 84% of the $5.8 billion plan; the $0.9 billion gap runs from $0.5 to $2.3 billion across scenarios

Need, identified sources and gap, baseline
$ million, 2026-2035



Funding gap by scenario
$ million over 2026-2035; gap as a share of need

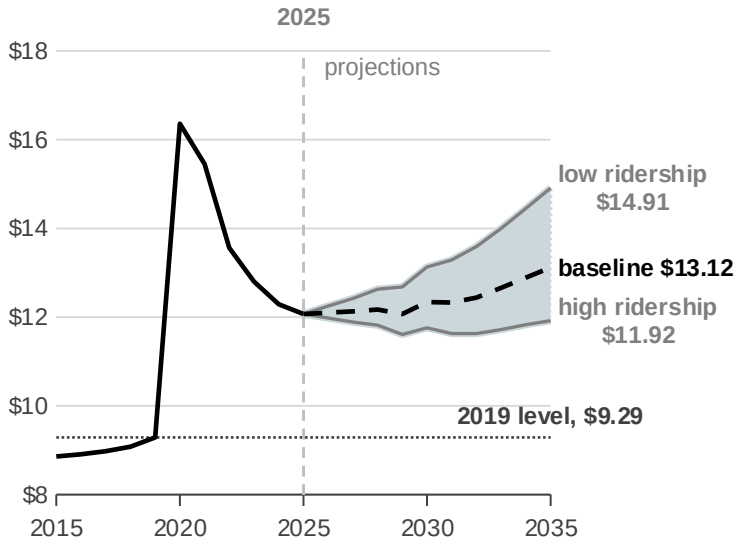
Scenario	What changes	Need	Funded	Gap	Share
Baseline	**as programmed**	**5,845**	**4,930**	**915**	**15.7%**
Sales tax renewed	+$450m from 2030	5,845	5,380	465	8.0%
Costs 8% higher	need +8%	6,313	4,930	1,383	21.9%
No federal grant	-$900m Blue Line	5,845	4,030	1,815	31.1%
Both downsides	both of the above	6,313	4,030	2,283	36.2%

Renewing the local sales tax roughly halves the gap, to $465 million; losing the Blue Line's federal grant roughly doubles it, to $1,815 million. Costs 8% over estimate add $468 million to it.

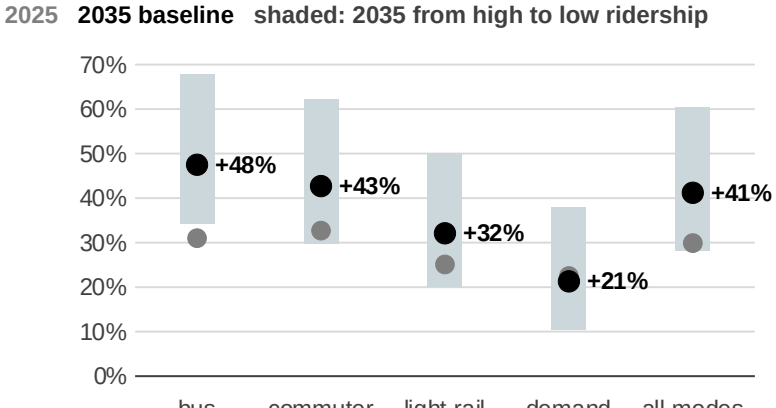
Data source: Lakeshore Regional Transit Authority, Ten-Year Capital and Ridership Outlook 2026 (fictional agency; illustrative figures)
Note: Federal grants = the Blue Line capital grant request. Costs 8% higher raises the whole plan 8%.

Cost per boarding stays above 2019's $9.29 in every case; bus's rises most, up 48% on 2019 by 2035

Operating cost per boarding, all modes, by ridership case
dollars, nominal



Change in cost per boarding since 2019, by mode
percent; dollars per boarding below



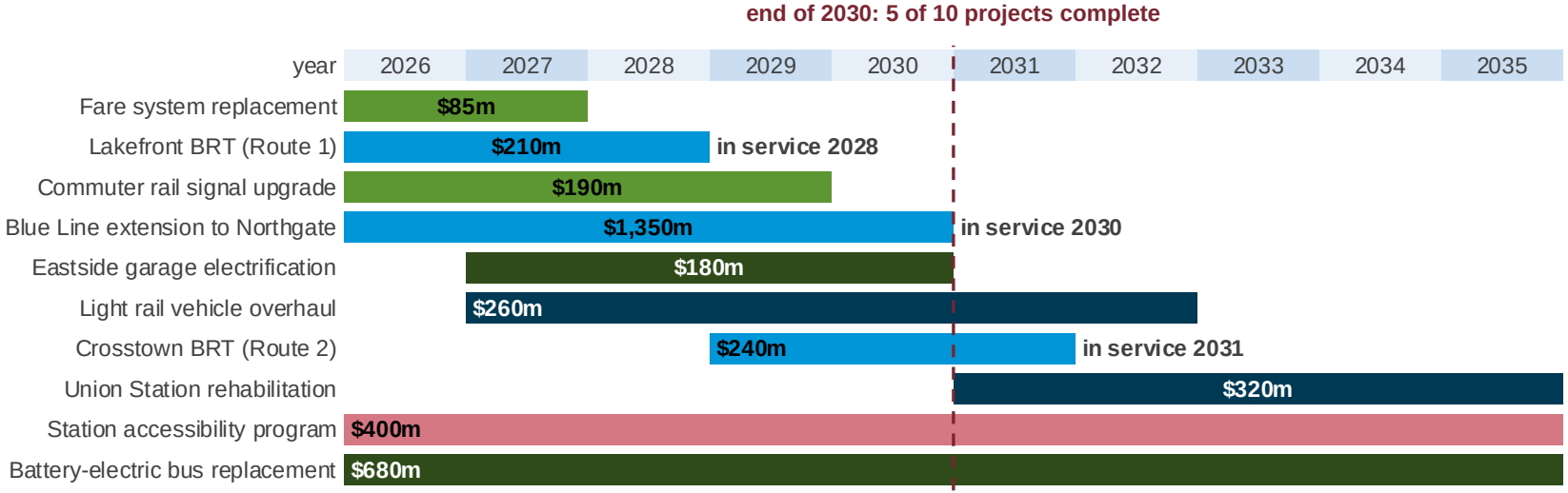
	bus	commuter rail	light rail	demand response	all modes
2019	$7.74	$15.79	$7.92	$57.14	$9.29
2035	**$11.42**	**$22.53**	**$10.46**	**$69.32**	**$13.12**

Data source: Lakeshore Regional Transit Authority, Ten-Year Capital and Ridership Outlook 2026 (fictional agency; illustrative figures)
Note: Cost per boarding = operating cost / boardings. The cases differ in ridership only; operating cost is the baseline's in all three. Demand response is per trip.

Five of ten major projects finish by 2030, including the $1.35 billion Blue Line extension; two programs run all decade

Major projects: years of construction and cost
bars span whole calendar years; cost in $ million, year of expenditure

state of good repair **expansion** **fleet and electrification** **stations and accessibility** **safety and systems**



Data source: Lakeshore Regional Transit Authority, Ten-Year Capital and Ridership Outlook 2026 (fictional agency; illustrative figures)
Note: Expansion projects show the year they enter service. Bar colours are the capital programs of page 4.